Germain Gauthier

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Research Interests

Fields: Applied microeconomics

Topics: Social media, Artificial intelligence, Gender, Crime, Protests, Elections

Methods: Microeconometrics, Machine learning, Deep learning

Positions

Assistant Professor of Economics, Bocconi University — Sept. 2023 – present
Department of Social and Political Sciences

Postdoctoral Researcher, ETH Zürich — Mar. – Aug. 2023
Law, Economics, and Data Science Group

Affiliations

CEPR (*AI and Democracy*)
CESifo Munich (*Economics of Digitization*)
IGIER & DONDENA (*AI and Society Initiative (DAISI), AXA Research Lab on Gender Equality*)

Visiting Positions

CESifo Munich — June 2026

Paris School of Economics — Mar.–Apr. 2026
Department of Economics

University of Lugano — Jan. 2026
Department of Economics

CESifo Munich — June 2024

ETH Zürich — 2020 / 2022
Center for Data Science, Law and Economics

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique — Sept. 2018–Aug. 2023
Center for Research in Economics and Statistics (CREST)

Advisor: Alessandro Riboni

M.Sc. Analysis and Policy in Economics, Paris School of Economics 2017–2018

M.Sc. Quantitative Economics, HEC Paris 2013–2017

B.A. Philosophy, Université La Sorbonne 2013–2014

Publications

1. **The Political Effects of 𝕏's Feed Algorithm**, with Roland Hodler, Philine Widmer, and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya (2026) *Nature*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-026-10098-2
2. **Relatio: Text Semantics Capture Political and Economic Narratives**, with Elliott Ash and Philine Widmer (2024) *Political Analysis*, 32(1): 115–132.
3. **Les déterminants de la mobilisation des Gilets jaunes**, Boyer, P. C., Delemotte, T., Gauthier, G., Rollet, V., & Schmutz, B. (2020) *Revue économique*, 71(1), 109–138.

Working Papers

4. **Automating Inequality? Gender Bias in AI-mediated Labor Markets**
   (with Kenza Elass, Debora Nozza, and Paola Profeta)
   Accepted at Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences
5. **Cycling through Elections: The Political Consequences of the Tour de France**
   (with Ala Alrababah, Maelle Delouis-Jost, and Adam Polak)
   Revise and resubmit at American Political Science Review
6. **The Lifecycle of Protests in the Digital Age**
   (with Pierre Boyer, Yves Le Yaouanq, Vincent Rollet, and Benoît Schmutz)
   Revise and resubmit at Journal of the European Economic Association
7. **Measuring Crime Reporting and Incidence: Method and Application to #MeToo**

Work in Progress

8. **Deep Latent Factor Models for the Social Sciences**
   (with Philine Widmer and Elliott Ash)
9. **The Neural Ideal Point Model**
   (with Hugo Subtil and Philine Widmer)
10. **Do Politicians Put Their Policies Where Their Mouths Are?**
    (with Caroline Le Pennec and Vincent Pons)
11. **On Differences in Social Media Consumption**
    (with Roland Hodler, Katharina Kaeppel, Alberto Ornaghi, and Philine Widmer)

12. **Algorithmic Amplification of Politics on Social Media**
    (with Philine Widmer and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya)
13. **Changing recommender algorithms**
    (with Philine Widmer)
    in preparation for the Cambridge Handbook of Digital Manipulation

Software

1. `deeplatent` – A Python package to estimate deep latent factor models.
2. `relatio` – A Python package to extract narrative statements from texts.

Teaching

Lectures

Undergraduate Public Finance (B.Sc., 48 hours), Bocconi	2023 – present
Diversity and Global Policy (M.Sc., 48 hours), Bocconi	2023 – present
Text as Data for the Social Sciences (Ph.D., with Philine Widmer), USI Lugano	2026
Text as Data for the Social Sciences (Ph.D., with Philine Widmer), LMU München	2022, 2023
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Paris Co-organizer of the event with Etienne Ollion (PI) and Félix Lennert Lectures on "Text as Data for the Social Sciences."	2022
Introduction to Working with Stata, M.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2020

Teaching Assistance

Econometrics, M.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2019
Econometrics, M.Sc. ENSAE	2018
Introduction to Economics, B.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2018, 2019
Macroeconomics, B.Sc. ENSAE	2018

Supervision and Mentoring

Participation in PhD committees: Nikola Noske (2026)	
Mentor of three Ph.D. students, Department of Social and Political Sciences, Bocconi (Ximena Caló, Tommaso Aicardi, Mohamed Horchani)	2026 – present
Supervisor of 20 Bachelor's and Master's theses, Bocconi	2023 – present

Administrative Experience and Professional Service

- Member of the *Teaching Innovation and AI Committee (TAIC)*, Bocconi — 2026 – present
- Member of the *AI and Social Sciences (AISS) Lab*, Bocconi — 2026 – present
- Co-organizer of the *DONDENA AI and Society Initiative (DAISI)*, Bocconi — 2023 – 2025

- Co-organizer of the inaugural *AI and Society Conference*, Bocconi, June 11–12, 2026 (13 invited speakers; keynote by Sendhil Mullainathan)
- Member of the scientific committee of *Monitoring Democracy (MoDe)*, Bocconi 2024 – present
- Member of the *Equal Opportunities Committee*, Bocconi 2024 – present
- Co-organizer of the *Summer Institute in Computational Social Science*, Paris (2022)
- Referee for *Nature*, *The American Economic Review*, *The Journal of Political Economy*, *The American Journal of Political Science*, *The Journal of Politics*, *The Economic Journal*, *Political Analysis*, *Journal of Population Economics*, *The European Journal of Political Economy*, *Social Science Research*, *Democratization*, *Nature Scientific Data*, *Economia Italiana*
- Referee for the book *Machine Learning for Econometrics (by Jeremy L'Hour and Christophe Gaillac)*
- Replication analyst for *Economic Policy* (2022/2023)

Grants and Awards

Bocconi Research Impact Award 2026
For *The Political Effects of 𝕏's Feed Algorithm* (*Nature*, 2026)

IGIER Junior Researchers' Grant (PI, 10K€) 2026

Bocconi Junior Researchers' Grant (PI, 10K€) 2026

Bocconi Innovation in Teaching Award (based on student evaluations) 2024

Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF) Project Grant (CHF 316,998) 2023–2026
Team member (PI: Roland Hodler)
Project: Social Media, Well-being, and Political Attitudes:
The Causal Effects of Recommender Algorithms

Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF) Grant (100K CHF) 2020
Team member (PI: Elliott Ash)
Project: Mining Narratives From Large Text Corpora

Laboratoire d'Excellence Ph.D. Grant 2018–2023
Project: Essays in Political Economy

Conferences and Presentations

USI Lugano, Paris School of Economics, Office of Communications (Ofcom), APSA, Zürich Summer School in AI and Applied Economics 2026

University of Milan, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Université Paris-Dauphine, Polmeth Europe, Comptext, URPP Conference on Gender Issues in Education and the Labor Market, "CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society", Venice Summer Institute Workshop on Digital Platforms, SPS Conference, Summer Institute on Computational Social Sciences (SICSS) at Lake Como 2025

CUSO Winter School in Behavioral Economics and Experimental Research (Champéry), Bocconi, ETH Zürich, ENS Lyon Advanced Methods Workshop, SPS Conference	2024
HEC Lausanne, Bocconi, University of Warwick, LMU München, Sciences Po, Erasmus University, University of St. Gallen, Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy	2023
Webinaire Economie Politique Francophone, University of St. Gallen, SICSS Paris, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime, ETH Zürich, University of Zürich, CREST	2022
ETH Zürich, Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics, Polmeth Europe, Polmeth US, Monash-Warwick-Zurich Conference, CREST	2021
Comptext, Université Paris-Nanterre, Paris School of Economics	2020
SICSS Zürich, Monash-Warwick-Zurich Conference, CREST	2019

Languages

French (native), English (fluent), German (good working knowledge), Italian (basic)

Python, R, Stata

References

Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, Paris School of Economics, ekaterina.zhuravskaya@psemail.eu

Roland Hodler, University of St.Gallen, roland.hodler@unisg.ch

Elliott Ash, ETH Zürich, ashe@ethz.ch

Alessandro Riboni, Ecole Polytechnique, alessandro.riboni@gmail.com

Xavier d'Haultfoeuille, ENSAE, xavier.dhaultfoeuille@ensae.fr